

## **Blink, or You'll Miss it**

***Or: Variations on The Love Song of J. Alfred Prufrock***

She sees it in the quiet moments  
in the hollow space between the shifting hands  
of the everlasting clock,  
chiming in the shadows  
behind your drooping eyes,  
dissolving in the sun's bare tooth grin  
whisked away by the somber tick... tick...

Boom!

Ah, there!

The smoky tail of a car caressing shameful, stagnant air  
it stains your reflection  
with remnants of its yellow sigh.

Behold!

Those fluttering paper wings  
which drip colorless paint on a bleak canvas  
up to the pale stage of a shattered heaven  
Hosting all the dead dreams, worms in our skulls

Let it live long  
in the cymbal crash  
screaming through the wind chimes,  
running from static shocks,  
pulled from decaying veins.

May it live the same way goosebumps rise,  
before a cool evening's breeze;  
nested in a lonely, forgotten corner  
of your skull's hollow attic

May you glimpse it,  
The sliver of a sight  
For the plucked out eye

But on the day your bruised and beaten hands  
wrap around the tendrils of its neck  
wrangle it into a cage and  
strip it naked,  
chain it's wrists in rough cords,  
string it up for all to see

*(Then you too, will finally see)*

you have made a rotting carcass of what can never die

and you will glimpse it no longer.